

Scientific Computing & Advanced Programming Lab

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Lecture-Slides-3



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From Data Structures to Objects

- ▶ So far, we have seen different ways of organising data.
- ▶ For example, a point can be represented using a tuple:
 $P = (3, 4)$
- ▶ We can store the data, but what about operations associated with that data?
- ▶ For a point, we might want to:
 - ▶ Find its distance from the origin.
 - ▶ Find its distance from another point.
 - ▶ Translate the point.
 - ▶ Find its polar coordinates.
- ▶ Instead of keeping the **data** and the **functions** separate, we can combine them into a single entity.

Data + Operations	→	Object
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Introduction to Object-Oriented Programming

- ▶ **Object-Oriented Programming (OOP)** organizes a program around **objects**.
- ▶ An object contains:
 - ▶ **Attributes** — data describing the object.
 - ▶ **Methods** — operations that the object can perform.

Example: A Point

Point
x, y
distance() translate() polar_coordinates()

- ▶ x and y are the **attributes**,
- ▶ the functions are the **methods**.

The object therefore combines the **state** of an entity with the **operations** that act on that state.



Classes and Objects

- ▶ A **class** is a blueprint for creating objects.
- ▶ An **object** is a particular instance of a class.
- ▶ The class defines what a `Point` contains and what it can do.
- ▶ We can then create different objects:

```
P = Point(3, 4)
```

```
Q = Point(7, 2)
```

Point class $\longrightarrow$ blueprint



$P = (3, 4)$

$Q = (7, 2)$

One class $\longrightarrow$ many objects



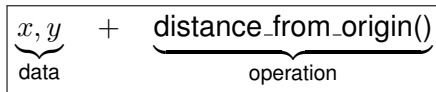
A First Mathematical Class: `Point`

- ▶ We want a Python object to represent a point $P = (x, y)$.
- ▶ The point should store its coordinates and calculate its distance from the origin.

```
class Point:
    def __init__(self, x, y):
        self.x = x
        self.y = y

    def distance_from_origin(self):
        return (self.x**2 + self.y**2)**0.5
```

The class combines:



Using the `Point` Class

- ▶ The class is a blueprint. We can create different **objects** from it.

```
P = Point(3, 4)
Q = Point(6, 8)
```

- ▶ Each object has its own coordinates:

```
print(P.x, P.y)      # 3 4
print(Q.x, Q.y)      # 6 8
```

- ▶ The same method works on different objects:

```
print(P.distance_from_origin()) # 5.0
print(Q.distance_from_origin()) # 10.0
```

One class	→	many independent objects
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Dissecting the Point Class

```
class Point:
```

- ▶ Defines a new type called `Point`.

```
def __init__(self, x, y):  
    self.x = x  
    self.y = y
```

- ▶ `__init__` initializes a new object.
- ▶ `self` refers to the particular object.
- ▶ `x` and `y` are input parameters.
- ▶ `self.x` and `self.y` are object attributes.

```
def distance_from_origin(self):  
    return (self.x**2 + self.y**2)**0.5
```

- ▶ A function defined inside a class is called a **method**.
- ▶ `self.x` and `self.y` refer to the coordinates of the



Functions vs. Methods

- ▶ A **function** is defined independently and receives the data it needs as arguments.

Ordinary Function

```
def distance(P, Q):  
    dx = P[0] - Q[0]  
    dy = P[1] - Q[1]  
    return (dx**2 + dy**2)**0.5  
  
P = (2, 3)  
Q = (8, 7)  
d = distance(P, Q)
```

- ▶ The same function is called independent of the points



Functions vs. Methods

- ▶ A **method** is a function defined inside a class and is called on an object.

Class Method

```
P = Point(2, 3)
```

```
Q = Point(8, 7)
```

```
d = P.distance_to(Q)
```

Function: `distance(P, Q)`

Method: `P.distance_to(Q)`

- ▶ **Key difference:** A method is associated with an object and can directly access that object's attributes through `self`.



Exercise: Extend the `Point` Class

- We have the `point` class defined as before

Task: Add the following features

1. Add a method `distance_to(other)` that calculates the distance between two points.
2. Add a method `translate(dx, dy)` that moves the point by

$$(x, y) \longrightarrow (x + dx, y + dy).$$

3. Add a method `midpoint(other)` that returns the midpoint between two points.

Test your class with

```
P = Point(2, 3)
```

```
Q = Point(8, 7)
```



Printing an Object

- ▶ Suppose we create a `Coordinate` object:

```
c = Coordinate(3, 4)
print(c)
```

- ▶ By default, Python produces something like:

```
<__main__.Coordinate object at 0x7fa918510488>
```

- ▶ This representation is not very informative!

How can we control what is displayed?

- ▶ Define a special `__str__` method for the class.
- ▶ Python automatically calls `__str__` when the object is used with `print()`.
- ▶ We decide what information should be displayed.



Extend the Point Class

- ▶ For example, we may want to add a method to display in the coordinate format (a, b) .

to produce

```
print(c)
```

$(3, 4)$

```
def __str__(self):  
    return "(" +str(self.x) + "," +str(self.y) + "
```

What is happening?

- ▶ `__str__` is a special method that defines the **string representation** of an object.
- ▶ `str(...)` converts the numerical coordinates into strings.
- ▶ The `+` operator joins the strings together.
- ▶ `print(P)` automatically calls `P.__str__()`.



How Does `print()` Use `__str__`?

- ▶ There is only one built-in `print()` function.
- ▶ When Python executes

```
print(P)
```

it asks the object for its string representation:

```
P.__str__()
```

- ▶ If the class defined, then Python uses this method automatically.

```
print(P) → P.__str__() → "(3, 4)"
```

Key idea: `__str__` tells Python how to represent objects of your class as a string.



OOP Exercise: Solving a 2×2 Linear System

Consider the linear system

$$a_{11}x + a_{12}y = b_1,$$

$$a_{21}x + a_{22}y = b_2.$$

For example:

- ▶ Design an object-oriented program to solve the system.
- ▶ **Partition the problem into 2–3 classes.**
- ▶ `Matrix` — stores the coefficient matrix and provides basic matrix operations.
- ▶ `Vector` — stores the right-hand side and solution vectors.
- ▶ `LinearSystem` — combines the matrix and vector and implements a method to solve

$$A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}.$$



OOP Exercise: Solving a 2×2 Linear System

Test your solver with

$$\begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 3 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 5 \\ 6 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Expected solution:

$$x = \frac{9}{5}, \quad y = \frac{7}{5}$$

